



BUSY LADY

IT HAS BEEN a hectic first three months for **Madhabi Puri Buch** as the chairperson of Sebi. The capital markets watchdog is now reviewing the IPO allotment framework, which, as per the government, is letting institutional

investors and HNIs exploit loopholes to artificially inflate subscription numbers. The signal came following the IPO of LIC, where some investors put in bids knowing well that they would get cancelled due to lack of funds in their bank accounts.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

DEAL DONE. NOW WHAT?

For Debashis Chatterjee, the mandate has got much larger. From being the big boss at Mindtree, he will now be in charge of the “LTI Mindtree” entity, India’s fifth-largest IT services company. The IT industry veteran will bank on all his experience to propel growth in a very challenging environment. Having spent over three decades with TCS and Cognizant before joining Mindtree, this will be the most high-profile position in his career. All eyes will be on him.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



IT industry veteran Debashis Chatterjee will bank on all his experience to propel growth in a very challenging environment



Time for Restraint

AT A POST-EARNINGS call, SoftBank CEO **Masayoshi Son** said the group may trim its planned investments by more than half as the global funding environment moves into a cautionary phase. SoftBank is among a handful of high-profile VC firms exercising restraint in investments as global macro events pound private markets.

—BINU PAUL

BIG BUYER, BIG BOOTS

Mukesh Ambani is looking to make another big-ticket acquisition. What’s new? This time it is Boots, the drugstore chain, a well-known name in the UK market. Media reports say Ambani is considering a joint bid with US buyout firm Apollo Global Management. If the deal goes through, one could see Boots expanding into India, Southeast Asia and the Middle-East. The ticket size is expected to be at least \$9 billion. Meanwhile, the retail piece now has Reliance Retail setting up a beauty and cosmetics segment and also a plan to buy over a large number of consumer brands.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



THE MINISTER’S POST

THE UNION CABINET recently approved additional funding of ₹820 crore for India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) to expand its services to all post offices. Currently, IPPB operates in 130,000 of the total 156,000 post offices. **Ashwini Vaishnaw**, Minister of Electronics & Information Technology, Railways and Communications, says the IPPB services “will include government programmes and other financial products to help provide financial inclusion at the bottom of the pyramid”.

—NIDHI SINGAL



Flying Expats

INDIA’S TWO BIGGEST AIRLINES now have foreign CEOs. After **Campbell Wilson**’s appointment as Air India’s CEO & MD, market leader IndiGo announced the appointment of **Pieter Elbers** (left) as its next CEO. Both come with impressive credentials, Wilson coming from Singapore Airlines’ low-cost subsidiary Scoot, and Elbers from KLM Royal Airlines. Tongues have started wagging on whether there’s no quality local talent available.

—MANISH PANT